



Time-based management

The general approach that recognizes the importance and value of time and seeks to reduce the level of unproductive time in an organization is called time-based management.

How it works

The fast pace of competition means a business that can manage time efficiently will enjoy a significant competitive advantage. This applies to new product development, faster response times to meet changing market and customer needs, and reduced waste. For a business to operate a time-based management system,

its people have to be multi-skilled and able to move swiftly between different tasks; its machinery has to be flexible so that production runs can be changed at short notice; and there has to be a culture of mutual trust between workers and managers. Time-based management is a key aspect of lean production.

Case study: managing time in Ford Electronics

Between 1988 and 1994, Ford Motor Company's electronics division implemented a number of change programs. One that used time-based management had a sustained and dramatic impact on the company's performance. A senior leader led the program with visits to the factory, where the focus was on the length of the production cycle and adding value at every stage. The factory worked with suppliers to improve shipment, reliability, and quality of raw materials used.

